

Dispute flow diagrams

Pre-arbitration & arbitration, scheme by scheme

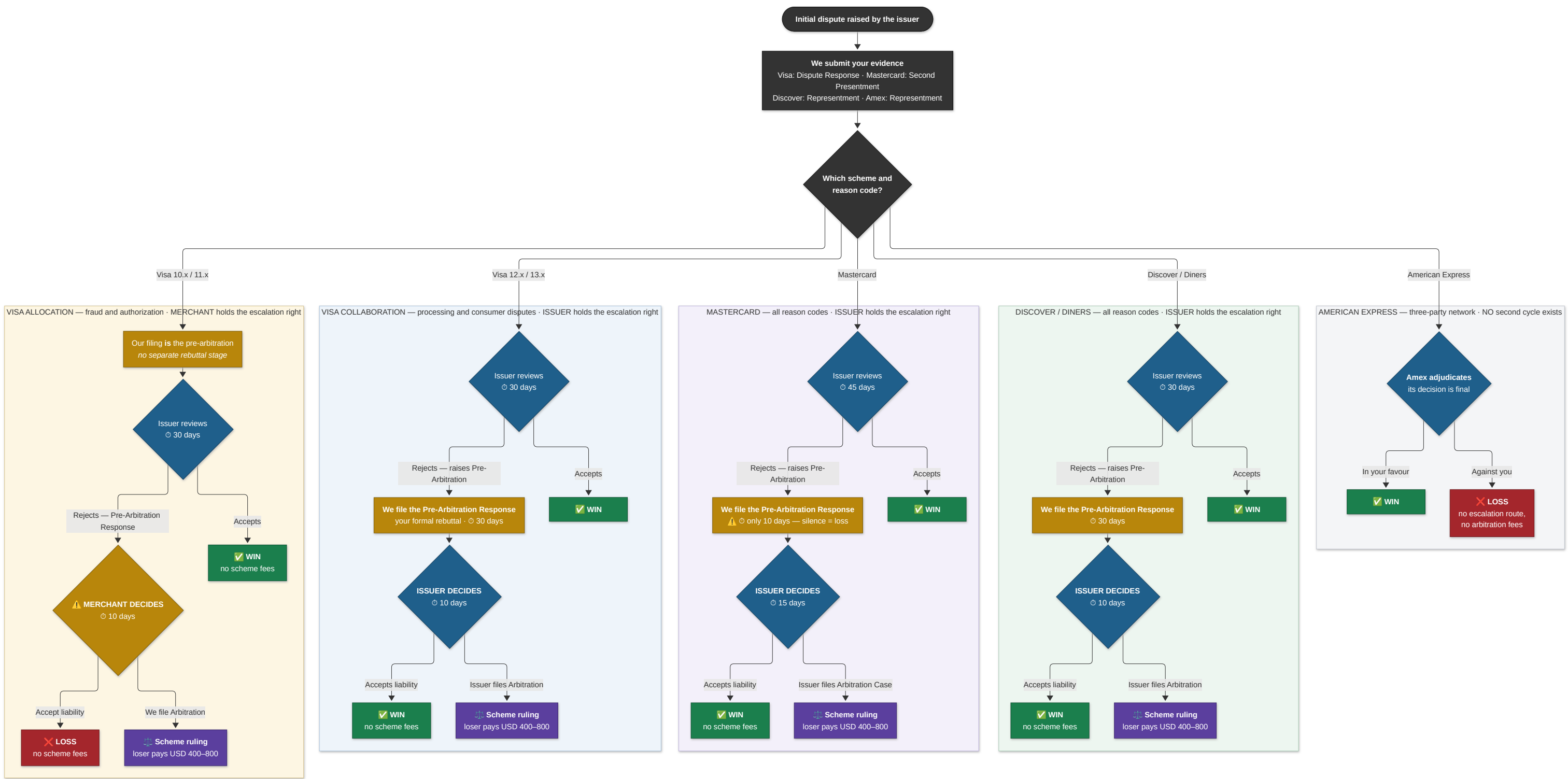
Every path that can follow an initial dispute outcome — who must act at each stage, how long they have, and what happens if nobody acts. Colour carries the message: gold is where you act, blue is where the issuer acts.

KEY

- Merchant / Checkout must act
- Issuer (or Amex) must act
- Outcome in your favour
- Chargeback stands
- Scheme arbitration — loser pays the fee

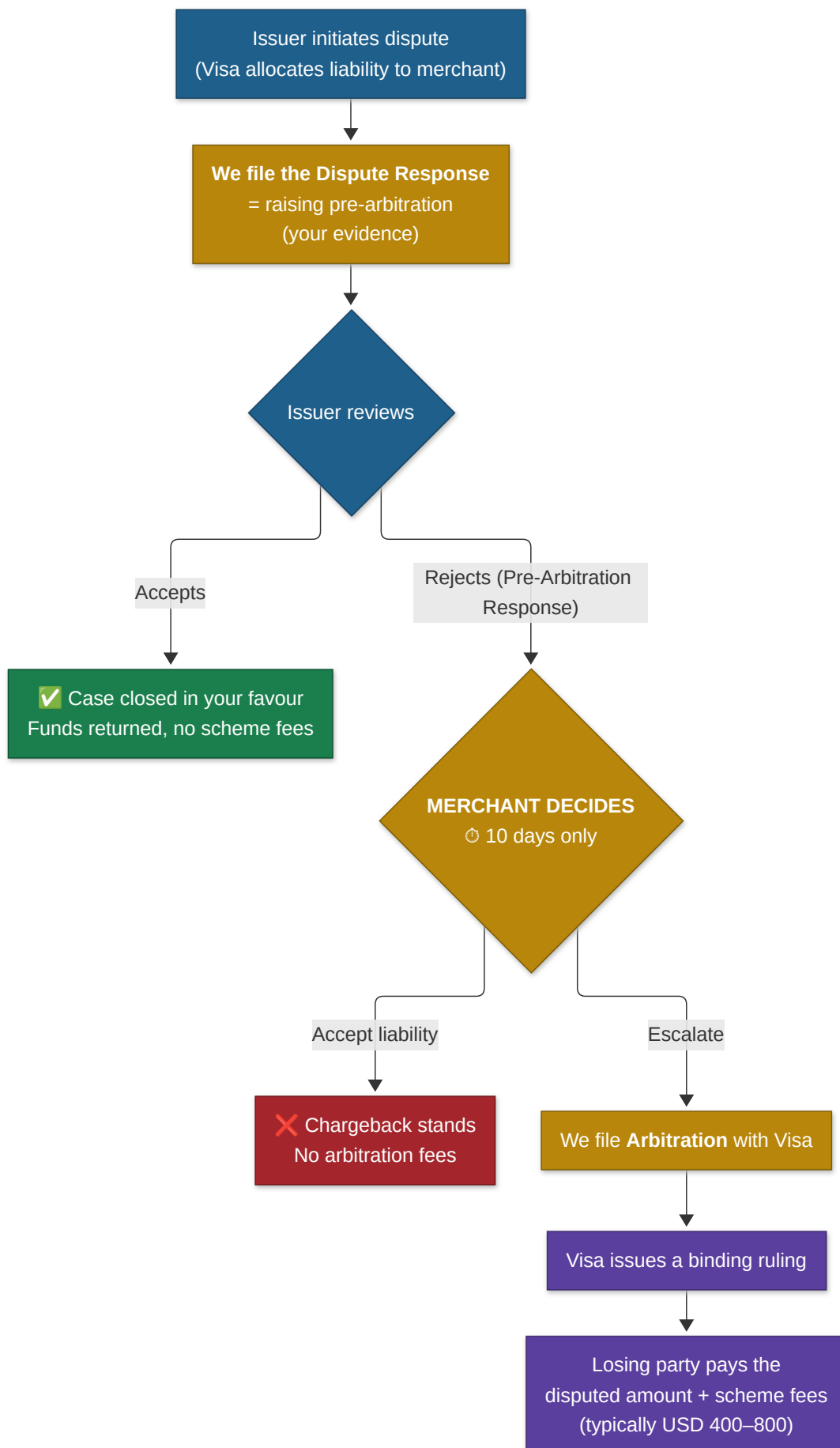
The complete map

Every path after an initial dispute outcome, all five scheme flows side by side



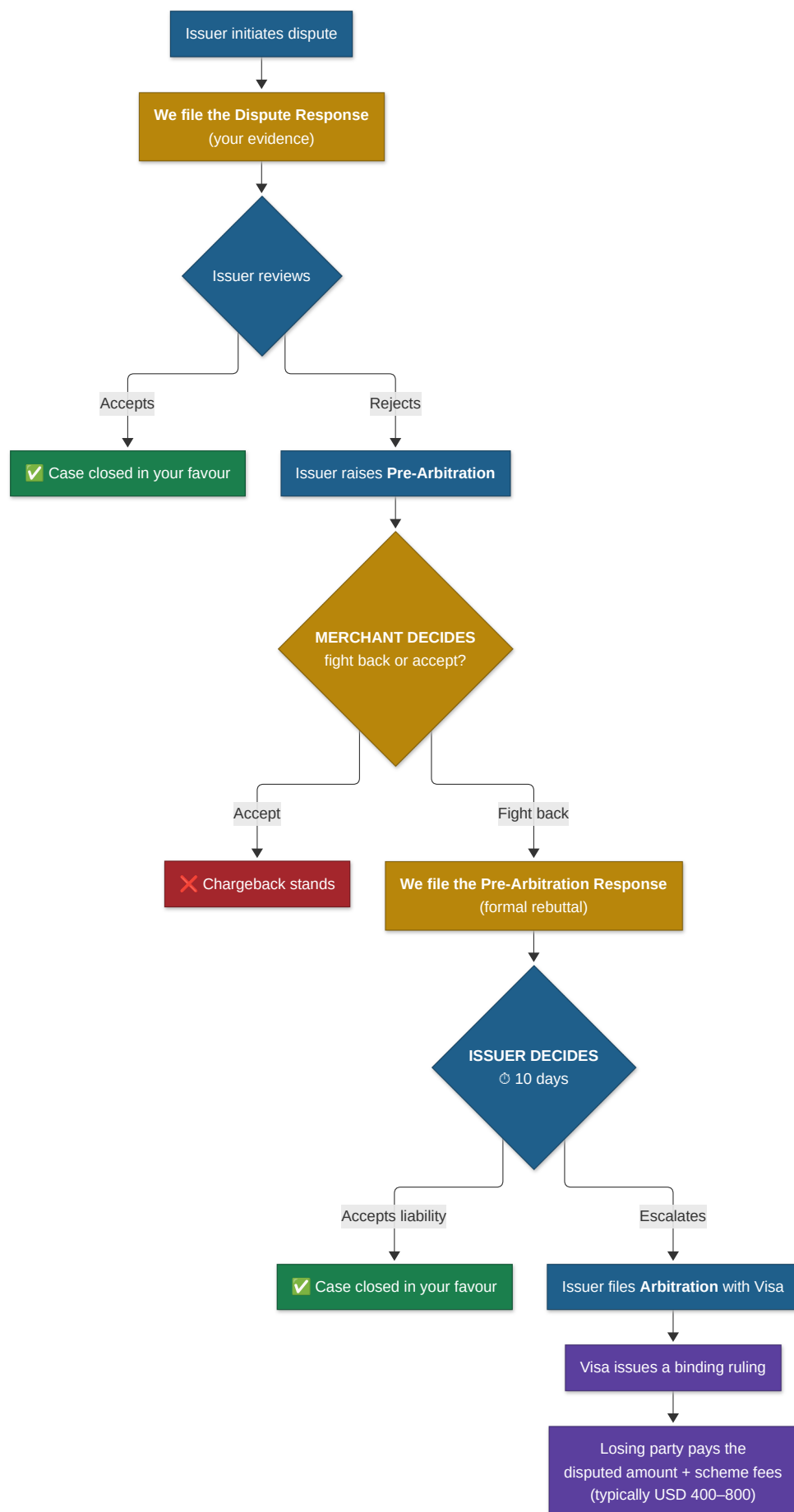
Visa — Allocation

Fraud (10.x) and authorization (11.x) · the merchant holds the escalation right



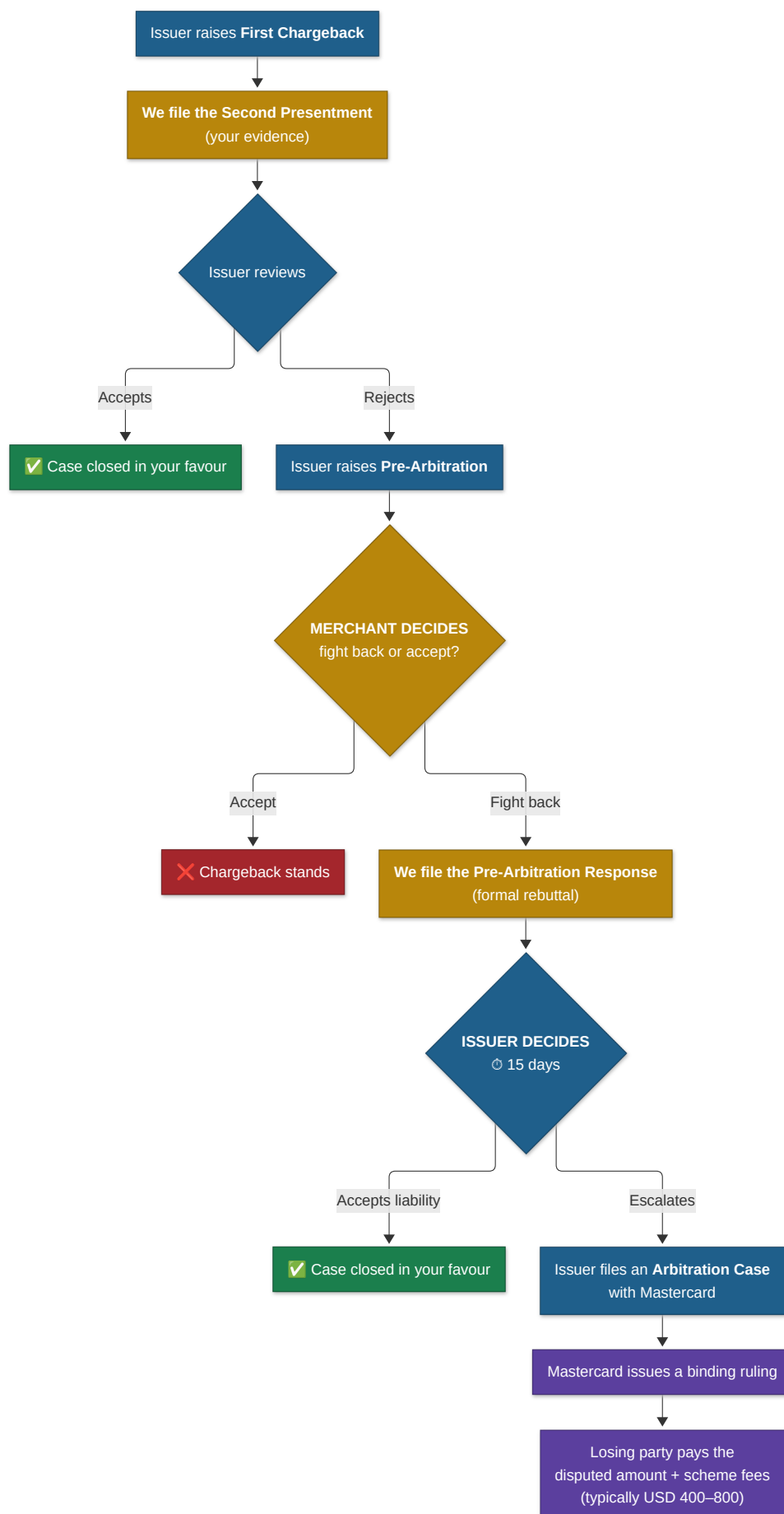
Visa — Collaboration

Processing errors (12.x) and consumer disputes (13.x) · the issuer escalates, 10 days



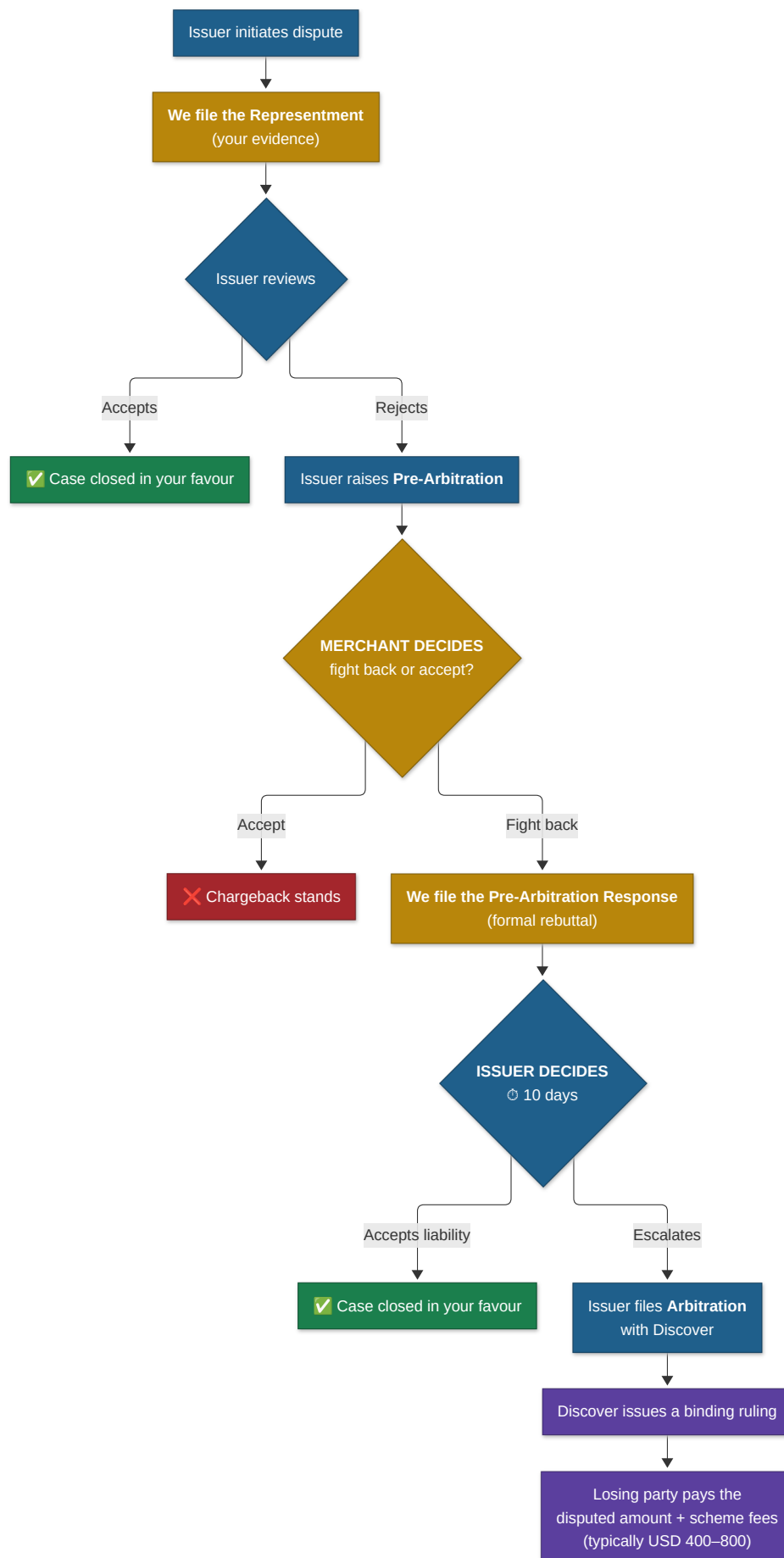
Mastercard

All reason codes · the issuer escalates, 15 days



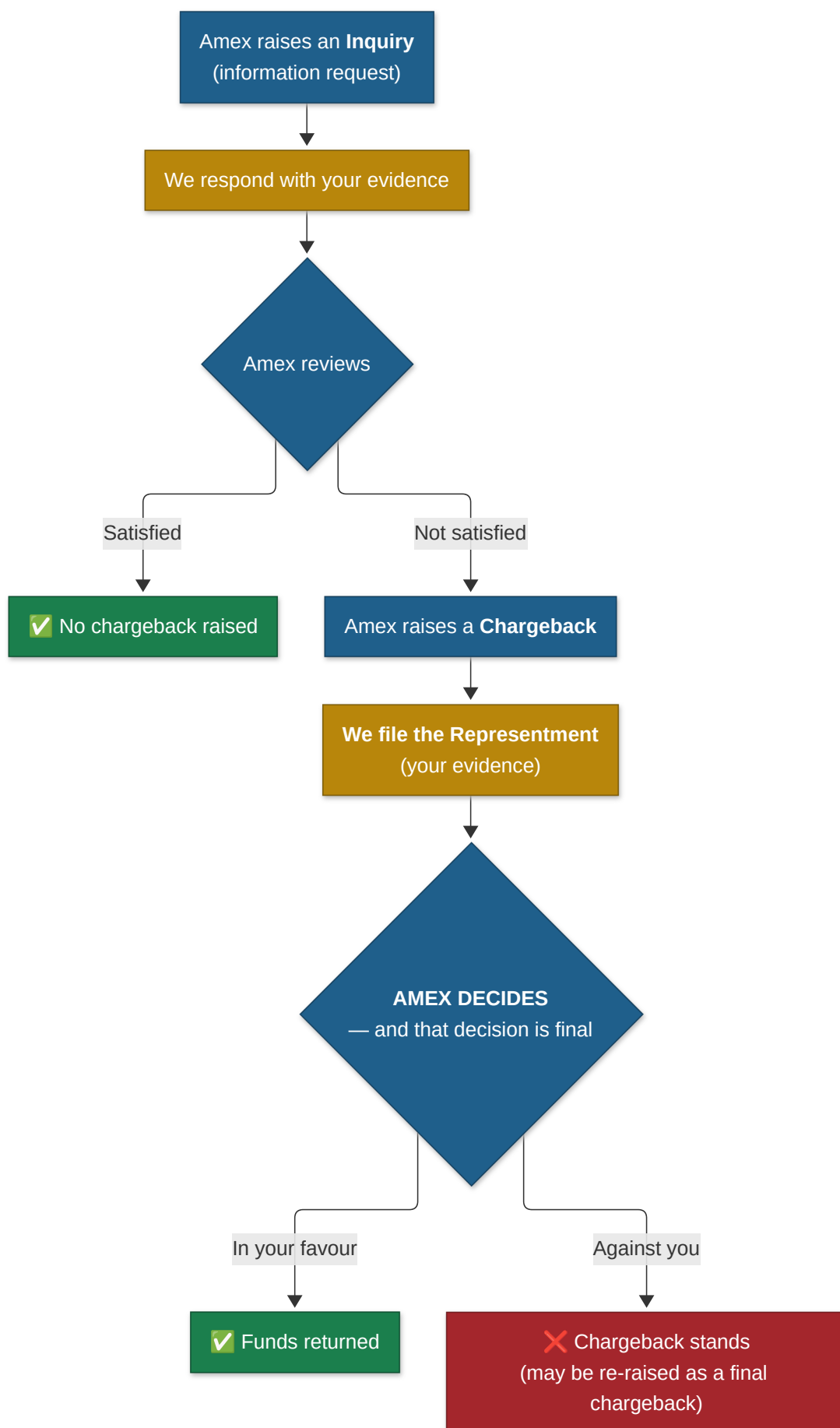
Discover / Diners Club

All reason codes · the issuer escalates, 10 days



American Express

Three-party network · no pre-arbitration or arbitration cycle exists



Quick decision guide

What to do once our first defence has been rejected

